EMPLOYEE POLICY HANDBOOK

Northstar Works (Fictional Company)

Sample policy document for testing a document-based RAG chatbot

***Important notice**: Northstar Works is fictional. This handbook is invented for educational and software-testing purposes only. It is not legal, HR, or employment advice and does not describe a real company's rules.*

1. Annual Leave Policy

Purpose. This policy explains how full-time employees request and use annual paid leave.

Annual allowance. Eligible full-time employees receive 20 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Employees who join during the year receive a prorated allowance based on their completed calendar months of service.

Request process. Submit annual-leave requests through the Northstar Works HR portal at least 10 calendar days before the first day of leave. The manager reviews requests based on team coverage, project deadlines, and the order in which requests were received. A request is not approved until the manager confirms it in the portal.

Carryover. Employees may carry over up to 5 unused annual-leave days into the next calendar year. Carried-over days must be used by 31 March; unused carried-over days expire after that date.

Short-notice requests. For unexpected circumstances, contact the manager as soon as practical. Approval depends on operational needs.

Leaving the company. The treatment or payment of unused annual leave when employment ends is not specified in this fictional handbook. Employees should ask HR for written clarification.

2. Sick Leave Policy

Purpose. This policy describes paid sick leave and notification steps when an employee is unwell.

Annual allowance. Full-time employees receive 10 paid sick days per calendar year. Sick leave is intended for the employee's illness, injury, or medical appointment that cannot reasonably be scheduled outside working hours.

Notification. Notify the manager and HR as soon as possible, preferably before the employee's scheduled start time. If the employee is unable to send the notice personally, a trusted person may notify the manager.

Medical documentation. For an absence of 3 or more consecutive working days, HR may request a medical certificate from a qualified healthcare professional. HR should request only documentation reasonably needed to verify the absence.

Unused balance. Unused sick days do not carry over to the next calendar year and are not paid out at year-end.

Extended illness. If an illness may require more than 5 consecutive working days away, the employee should contact HR to discuss available leave options. This handbook does not specify disability benefits or statutory entitlements.

Privacy. Medical information shared for leave administration must be handled confidentially and accessed only by staff who need it for their work.

3. Working Hours and Attendance Policy

Standard schedule. The normal schedule for full-time office employees is Monday through Friday, 9:00 a.m. to 5:30 p.m., with a 30-minute unpaid lunch break. This represents 40 working hours per week.

Flexible start time. With prior manager approval, employees may start between 8:00 a.m. and 10:00 a.m. They must complete their scheduled daily working hours and coordinate their schedule with their team.

Core collaboration hours. All office-based employees are expected to be available for meetings and collaboration from 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m., except during approved leave or breaks.

Attendance and lateness. If an employee expects to arrive more than 10 minutes late, they should notify their manager before the scheduled or approved start time. Repeated lateness may lead to a manager discussion and a documented improvement plan.

Overtime. Employees must obtain written manager approval before working overtime. The method of overtime compensation or time off is not specified in this fictional handbook and must be confirmed with HR.

Public holidays. The company holiday calendar is published by HR each year. This handbook does not list specific holiday dates.

4. Remote Work Policy

Eligibility. Employees who have completed probation may request remote work, subject to role suitability, performance, data-security requirements, and manager approval. Some roles may require on-site attendance.

Regular arrangement. Eligible employees may request up to 2 remote-work days per week. Requests must be submitted to the manager at least 5 working days before the proposed start date. The arrangement begins only after written approval.

Availability. Remote employees must be reachable during their agreed working hours, attend scheduled meetings, and keep their calendar current. Core collaboration hours of 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. still apply unless the manager approves an exception in writing.

Equipment and security. Employees must use company-approved devices and secure access methods, protect confidential information from being viewed by others, and report lost devices or suspected data exposure to IT immediately.

Changes or cancellation. Managers may review remote-work arrangements every 3 months. The company may change or end an arrangement when business needs, performance, or security concerns require it; the manager should explain the reason to the employee.

Expenses. This handbook does not specify reimbursement for home internet, electricity, furniture, or other home-office expenses. Employees should ask HR before incurring expenses they expect the company to cover.

5. Probation Policy

Duration. New employees serve a 3-month probation period beginning on their first day of employment.

Review process. The manager should hold a check-in around the end of the first month and a formal performance review during the final two weeks of probation. Reviews consider role-related performance, reliability, collaboration, conduct, and completion of agreed goals.

Confirmation. Successful completion of probation is confirmed in writing by HR. Employees should not assume confirmation is automatic if they have not received written notice.

Extension. If additional time is reasonably needed to assess performance, HR may approve one probation extension of up to 2 months. The employee must receive written notice before the original probation period ends, including the reason and revised review date.

Support and feedback. Managers should explain expectations, provide actionable feedback, and identify reasonable support or training where appropriate.

Remote work during probation. Employees on probation are generally not eligible for regular remote-work arrangements. A manager may approve an occasional remote day for exceptional circumstances in writing.

Notice and termination. This handbook does not specify notice periods, termination procedures, or compensation related to ending employment during or after probation. Employees should ask HR for the applicable written terms.

End of handbook. *This five-page fictional document intentionally leaves certain matters unspecified so that a RAG chatbot can be tested on whether it avoids inventing answers.*